

MUS 262 – Quiz 2

Predicted Questions & Answers

Complete Study Guide for Quick Memorization

Weeks 5-7: Hard Bop, Modal Jazz, Free Jazz

■ CRITICAL: ~30% of Quiz 2 = THREE-WAY COMPARISONS ■

Focus Area: Be able to compare Hard Bop vs Modal vs Free Jazz on ANY dimension.
See comprehensive comparison tables in Section 2.

Hard Bop =	CHURCH SOUL GROOVE
Modal Jazz =	MODES SPACE MEDITATION
Free Jazz =	NO RULES CHAOS

Use these to build ANY comparison on the quiz!

SECTION 1: PREDICTED QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

MUSICAL INFLUENCES QUESTIONS

Q1: What is one characteristic of gospel music that influenced hard bop?

ANSWER: Call-and-response patterns, syncopated rhythms, soulful emotional expression rooted in Black church music, blues scale and 'bent' notes from spiritual singing.

MEMORY AID: Hard Bop = Church Soul

Q2: How did R&B; influence hard bop in the 1950s?

ANSWER: R&B; brought funky, danceable grooves and strong backbeat emphasis (beats 2 and 4) that made the music more accessible. R&B;'s riff-based melodies and earthy, soulful quality gave hard bop its characteristic 'soul jazz' sound.

MEMORY AID: R&B; = Funky Groove Dance

Q3: How did Eastern/Indian music influence modal jazz in the 1960s?

ANSWER: Eastern music influenced modal jazz through the use of drones/pedal points and repetitive modal patterns that created meditative, trance-like qualities. This spiritual seeking reflected Eastern philosophy, particularly in Coltrane's work.

MEMORY AID: Modal + India = Trance Meditation Drone

READING CONCEPTS QUESTIONS

Q4: What does Ingrid Monson mean by 'saying something' in jazz?

ANSWER: 'Saying something' means jazz musicians communicate emotional depth, cultural references, and personal identity through their playing. It's about musical conversation where instruments 'speak' to each other with meaning beyond just notes.

MEMORY AID: Monson = Music as Language (instruments talking with meaning)

Q5: What does Paul Berliner mean by 'thinking in jazz'?

ANSWER: 'Thinking in jazz' means developing an internalized vocabulary of patterns, phrases, and harmonic concepts that become second nature through intensive practice and listening. Musicians spontaneously recall and recombine this mental library during improvisation.

MEMORY AID: Berliner = Mental Library + Automatic (learned patterns become spontaneous)

Q6: According to Szwed, what is 'soul jazz' and how does it relate to hard bop?

ANSWER: Soul jazz is a substyle of hard bop that emphasized funky, gospel-influenced grooves closely tied to Black church music and R&B.; It featured simpler harmonies, repeated riffs, and organ-based groups, with Horace Silver as a key figure.

MEMORY AID: Soul Jazz = Hard Bop + Church Funk (Horace Silver)

THREE-WAY COMPARISON QUESTIONS

■ CRITICAL SECTION – 30% OF QUIZ ■

Q7: How does Hard Bop (Week 5) differ from Modal Jazz (Week 6)? Name two differences.

ANSWER:

- (1) **Harmony:** Hard Bop uses complex, rapid chord changes; Modal Jazz uses minimal harmony (one or two modes per section).
- (2) **Rhythm/Feel:** Hard Bop emphasizes strong, locked-in groove; Modal Jazz has more spacious, floating feel.

MEMORY AID: **Hard Bop** = Complex Chords + Strong Groove; **Modal** = Simple Modes + Floating Space

Q8: What are two musical differences between Modal Jazz (Week 6) and Free Jazz (Week 7)?

ANSWER:

- (1) **Harmony:** Modal Jazz uses modes/scales as structure with tonal center; Free Jazz has no predetermined harmony and is atonal.
- (2) **Form:** Modal Jazz still has structure (modes, pulse); Free Jazz abandons all predetermined forms.

MEMORY AID: **Modal** = Structure with Modes; **Free** = NO Structure, NO Rules

Q9: How does Free Jazz (Week 7) differ from Hard Bop (Week 5)? Name two ways.

ANSWER:

- (1) **Rhythm:** Hard Bop has strong, steady groove with walking bass; Free Jazz has no steady pulse (free time).
- (2) **Structure:** Hard Bop uses traditional forms (AABA, blues); Free Jazz abandons all fixed forms.

MEMORY AID: **Hard Bop** = Groove + Structure; **Free** = Chaos + Freedom

Q10: How did Modal Jazz (Week 6) emerge from Hard Bop (Week 5)?

ANSWER: Musicians sought freedom from Hard Bop's complex chord progressions. Modal jazz simplified harmony by using modes/scales instead of rapid chord changes, allowing more space for melodic exploration and contemplation. Miles Davis and John Coltrane led this shift.

MEMORY AID: **Hard Bop** → **Modal** = Too Many Changes → Simplify to Modes

Q11: Why did Free Jazz (Week 7) emerge from Modal Jazz (Week 6)?

ANSWER: Even modal structures felt limiting – modes were still 'rules.' In the Civil Rights era context, musicians sought complete artistic freedom by abandoning all predetermined structures (harmony, form, meter), reflecting the connection between musical freedom and social/political freedom.

MEMORY AID: **Modal** → **Free** = Even Modes = Rules → Break ALL Rules (Civil Rights era)

ARTIST COMPARISON QUESTIONS

Q12: How do tenor saxophonists Sonny Rollins and John Coltrane differ in their approach?

ANSWER:

- (1) Rollins is more playful and rhythmically inventive with Caribbean influences; Coltrane is more spiritually intense and harmonically complex.
- (2) Rollins focuses on melodic development; Coltrane used 'sheets of sound' and modal/spiritual exploration.

MEMORY AID: Rollins = Playful Calypso; Coltrane = Spiritual Sheets

Q13: Compare Miles Davis's approaches in 'Oleo' (Hard Bop) vs. 'So What' (Modal Jazz).

ANSWER:

- (1) 'Oleo': fast bebop tempo with rapid chord changes requiring virtuosic harmony navigation.
- (2) 'So What': slow, spacious modal approach with just two modes emphasizing melodic development over technical display.

MEMORY AID: 'Oleo' = Fast Complex; 'So What' = Slow Simple

Q14: How does Horace Silver's piano style differ from Bill Evans' impressionistic approach?

ANSWER:

- (1) Silver: funky, gospel-influenced, accessible with clear melodic ideas; founded soul jazz.
- (2) Evans: impressionistic, classical-influenced, delicate with colorful harmonic voicings and chamber jazz approach.

MEMORY AID: Silver = Church Funk; Evans = French Impressionist

Q15: How does Ornette Coleman's free jazz approach differ from Charlie Parker's bebop?

ANSWER:

- (1) Harmony: Coleman abandoned chord changes entirely (free improvisation); Parker mastered complex, rapid chord changes.
- (2) Tone: Coleman used raw, vocal-like plastic alto sax; Parker had pure, controlled bebop tone on brass sax.

MEMORY AID: Coleman = No Changes, Raw Plastic; Parker = Complex Changes, Pure Brass

DEFINING CHARACTERISTICS QUESTIONS

Q16: Name two defining characteristics of Hard Bop (Week 5).

ANSWER:

- (1) Gospel/blues/R&B; influence: incorporated Black church music and R&B; into bebop, creating funkier, more soulful sound.
- (2) Strong rhythm section: emphasized groove and swing with powerful, interactive drumming (Art Blakey style).

MEMORY AID: Hard Bop = Church Soul + Strong Groove

Q17: Name two defining characteristics of Modal Jazz (Week 6).

ANSWER:

- (1) Scale-based improvisation: used modes/scales instead of chord progressions as harmonic foundation.
- (2) Spaciousness: slower tempos and less harmonic density created room for melodic exploration and contemplation.

MEMORY AID: Modal Jazz = Modes + Space + Meditation

Q18: Name two defining characteristics of Free Jazz (Week 7).

ANSWER:

- (1) No predetermined harmony: completely abandoned chord progressions and tonal centers with atonal improvisation.
- (2) Collective improvisation: all musicians improvised simultaneously without soloist/accompanist roles or fixed forms.

MEMORY AID: Free Jazz = NO Rules + Collective Chaos

SECTION 2: COMPREHENSIVE COMPARISON TABLES

(Master these for the 30% comparison questions)

QUICK IDENTIFICATION GUIDE

Question	HARD BOP	MODAL JAZZ	FREE JAZZ
Can you tap a steady beat?	YES – strong groove	YES – floating pulse	NO – free time
Chord changes?	MANY – rapid, complex	FEW – static (1-2 modes)	NONE – atonal
Overall vibe?	Funky, soulful, grooving	Meditative, spacious, floating	Chaotic, intense, confrontational
Sounds like?	Church + blues + dance	Classical impressionism + Eastern meditation	Breaking all rules + screaming chaos

THE ESSENTIAL COMPARISON TABLE

Dimension	HARD BOP	MODAL JAZZ	FREE JAZZ
HARMONY	Complex, rapid chord changes (bebop style)	Simple – 1-2 modes per section; static	NONE – completely atonal
RHYTHM/TEMPO	Strong, locked-in groove; medium-fast	Spacious, floating feel; slow-medium	Variable or FREE TIME – no pulse
FORM	Traditional (AABA, 12-bar blues)	Simplified forms; long vamps	NO predetermined forms
BASS ROLE	Walking bass keeping time	Pedal tones or ostinatos	Melodic, free lines
DRUMS ROLE	Driving, interactive (Art Blakey)	Subtle, supportive; brushwork	Textural, non-metrical
INFLUENCES	Gospel, blues, R&B, church	Impressionism (Debussy), Eastern	Avant-garde classical
SOUND	Funky, earthy, swinging, soulful	Floating, meditative, contemplative	Intense, chaotic, confrontational
KEY ARTISTS	Blakey, Silver, Rollins, Mingus	Miles, Coltrane, Evans, Hancock	Coleman, Taylor, Dolphy, Ayler

THE PROGRESSIVE LIBERATION

Think of these three weeks as stages of **increasing freedom**:

Week 5: HARD BOP

Freed jazz from: Pure intellectualism

By adding: Soul, groove, Black cultural identity

But kept: Complex harmony, virtuosity, traditional forms

Week 6: MODAL JAZZ

Freed jazz from: Constant chord changes

By using: Modes and static harmony

But kept: Structure (modes), pulse, beauty

Week 7: FREE JAZZ

Freed jazz from: All traditional rules

By abandoning: Harmony, form, meter

But kept: Improvisation, intensity, expression

FINAL TIPS FOR QUIZ DAY

When Listening to Unknown Track:

1. **Can you tap a steady beat?** Yes → Hard Bop or Modal Jazz; No → Free Jazz
2. **Are chords changing frequently?** Yes → Hard Bop; No → Modal or Free Jazz
3. **Is there a clear tonal center?** Blues/gospel feel → Hard Bop; Spacious/floating → Modal Jazz; Atonal/chaotic → Free Jazz

For the Writing Response:

- Use specific vocabulary from each week
- Mention 5-6 concrete observations
- Connect musical characteristics to the style/period
- Reference specific techniques or concepts

You've got this! ■